

Learning and Development Policy

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1. Purpose and Scope

This policy defines Acme Corp's framework for employee learning, career development, and internal mobility. Its purpose is to ensure employees have access to the skills, experiences, and opportunities needed to grow — both for their own benefit and for the sustained capability of the organization.

This policy covers development programs, internal mobility, mentorship, and the use of the development budget. It does not govern:

- The dollar amount of education reimbursement (governed by POL-BEN-005 §10.2, which defines the annual \$5,250 cap and conditions)
- Mandatory compliance training (Security Awareness, Anti-Harassment, etc.) which are requirements owned by IT Security and People Operations respectively
- The 90-day onboarding curriculum (governed by POL-ONB-006)

2. Development Planning

2.1 Individual Development Plans (IDPs)

Every employee is expected to maintain an Individual Development Plan (IDP) in Workday Learning, updated at minimum annually during the goal-setting cycle each January (see POL-PFM-010 §3).

An IDP should capture:

- Career aspirations: Where the employee wants to grow over the next 1–3 years
- Skill gaps: Capabilities needed for the current role or next role that require development
- Development actions: Specific activities (courses, projects, stretch assignments, mentorship) with target completion dates
- Manager input: Manager's perspective on growth priorities and available opportunities

2.2 Manager Responsibility

Managers are expected to:

- Discuss and co-create IDPs with each direct report
- Actively surface development opportunities (stretch projects, cross-team collaboration, conference speaking)
- Dedicate time in 1:1s to development conversations — not just status updates
- Be evaluated on team development as part of their own annual performance review (POL-PFM-010 §6.4)

3. Learning Resources

3.1 Internal Learning Catalog

Acme Corp maintains an internal learning catalog in Workday Learning, which includes:

- Recorded internal training sessions and workshops
- Onboarding and compliance modules (assigned automatically by role)
- Manager effectiveness curriculum (required for all people managers within 30 days of assuming a management role)
- Technical skill paths curated by the Engineering and Product teams

3.2 External Learning Platforms

All employees have access to the following company-provided learning platforms at no cost:

- LinkedIn Learning: Self-paced online courses across technical, professional, and leadership topics
- O'Reilly Learning: Technical books, courses, and certifications for engineering and data roles
- Coursera for Business: University-level courses and professional certificates

Access is provisioned through the IT Portal on Day 1 for all employees.

3.3 Education Assistance Program

Employees seeking tuition reimbursement for formal degree or certification programs at accredited institutions should refer to POL-BEN-005 §10.2, which governs eligibility, dollar limits, approval process, and the service commitment that applies.

4. Professional Development Budget

4.1 Per-Employee Annual Budget

In addition to the education assistance program, each employee has a Professional Development Budget for job-related activities not covered by tuition reimbursement:

| Level | Annual Budget |

|---|---|

| L1 – L4 | \$750 |

| L5 – L6 | \$1,500 |

| L7 – L8 | \$3,000 |

| L9 – L10 | Discretionary (VP approval) |

4.2 Eligible Uses

The professional development budget may be used for:

- Industry conferences and summits (registration fees, see Section 4.3 for travel)
- Technical certifications and exam fees
- Workshops and bootcamps (in-person or virtual)
- Books and learning materials above the \$200 no-approval threshold in POL-BEN-005 §10.2
- Professional memberships and association dues relevant to the role

Recurring SaaS subscriptions must be approved by IT for security compliance (see POL-SEC-004 §9.1) before using the development budget.

4.3 Travel for Development Activities

Travel costs (flights, hotel, meals) for approved development activities are reimbursable through the professional development budget above, subject to the travel limits defined in the Expense Reimbursement Policy (POL-EXP-001 §3). Travel must be pre-approved by the employee's manager.

4.4 Approval and Reimbursement

- Expenses up to \$500 require manager approval in Workday.
- Expenses above \$500 require manager and HR Business Partner approval.
- Submit receipts through Expensify per standard expense procedures (POL-EXP-001 §2.4).
- Budgets reset on January 1st annually; unused budget does not roll over.

5. Conference Attendance

5.1 Speaking at Conferences

Employees who are invited to speak at industry conferences are encouraged to do so. Conference registration fees and travel for speaking engagements are fully covered by the company (not drawn from the individual development budget), with VP approval and advance notice of at least 30 days.

All presentations representing Acme Corp require review by Communications before submission. Public commentary on company strategy, roadmap, or financials requires explicit clearance (see POL-WPC-009 §6.3).

5.2 Attending as a Company Representative

Department heads may approve team members to attend conferences as Acme Corp representatives (e.g., to recruit, network, or gather competitive intelligence). These costs are covered by the department's event budget, not the individual's development budget.

6. Mentorship Program

6.1 Program Overview

Acme Corp operates a voluntary cross-functional Mentorship Program twice per year (cohorts start in January and July). The program pairs employees seeking development in specific areas with more experienced mentors across the organization.

6.2 Participation

- Mentees: Any employee at L1–L7 may apply as a mentee.
- Mentors: Employees at L5 and above with at least 2 years at Acme Corp may volunteer as mentors.
- Matches are made by People Operations based on development goals, not reporting relationships (managers may not mentor their own direct reports in the formal program).

6.3 Structure and Commitment

- Each cohort runs for 6 months.
- Pairs are expected to meet for at least 1 hour per month.
- People Operations provides a structured conversation guide and check-in surveys at 3 months.
- Participation counts toward the mentor's people leadership evaluation (if applicable).

7. Internal Mobility

7.1 Philosophy

Acme Corp believes internal talent is a strategic asset. Employees are encouraged to explore roles across the organization; managers are expected to support internal movement rather than block it.

7.2 Eligibility to Apply for Internal Roles

Employees may apply for internal job postings if they:

- Have been in their current role for a minimum of 12 months
- Hold a current performance rating of 3 or above
- Are not on an active Performance Improvement Plan

Exceptions to the 12-month minimum require the current manager's written consent.

7.3 Internal Application Process

1. Employee notifies their current manager before or at the time of applying (not after receiving an offer). Surprise transitions damage team planning and are discouraged.
2. Employee applies through the internal jobs portal in Workday. Internal applicants are identified to the hiring team.
3. Internal candidates receive a response (advance or decline) within 10 business days of applying.
4. If selected, the transfer date is negotiated between the hiring manager and current manager, typically 4–6 weeks after offer acceptance to allow for transition.

7.4 Compensation on Transfer

Internal transfers are evaluated for compensation adjustment based on the new role's pay band (see POL-CMP-012 §3.2). Lateral moves do not automatically result in a compensation increase; promotions via transfer follow the promotion compensation guidelines in POL-CMP-012 §4.3.

8. Contact and Questions

- People Operations (IDPs, mentorship, internal mobility): people-ops@acmecorp.com
- Workday Learning: hr.acmecorp.internal/learning

- LinkedIn Learning / O'Reilly access: IT Portal
- Development budget approvals: Via Workday expense workflow